Household Pulse Survey User Notes

Phase 4.0

Date: March 26, 2026

Health Table 8 update

Health Table 8 and Standard Error Health Table 8 in Phase 4.0 (Cycles 1-3) have been updated to correctly populate the estimates in column H (HADCOVIDRV=1 and LONGCOVID=2). The data in column H were previously blank due to a programming error that caused the data in column H to be combined with data in column G (HADCOVIDRV=1 and LONGCOVID=1 and SYMPTMIMPCT in (–99,.m)).

This table update corrects the previously reported estimate for "Total" and "Did not report" for question "Did you have any symptoms lasting 3 months or longer that you did not have prior to having coronavirus or COVID-19?". The underlying HPS data used to generate the estimates for the tables as well as the PUF were correct and are not impacted by this update.

Phase 4.0

Date: March 21, 2024

Title Update for Data Tables Health 6a, 6b, and 6c

We have implemented a minor update to the titles of Data Tables Health 6a, 6b, and 6c to further specify their content. These three tables were all previously titled, "Social and Emotional Support" without additional differentiation. Below is text added to the respective tables to further differentiate their content:

Table 6a. Social and Emotional Support **and Feelings of Loneliness,** by Select Characteristics
Table 6b. Social and Emotional Support: **Telephone and Text Communication,** by Select Characteristics
Table 6c. Social and Emotional Support: **Community Engagement**, by Select Characteristics

This change is strictly a label correction and does not impact the underlying data.

Phase 4.0

Date: February 22, 2024

Release Note on Phase 4.0 Collection of the Household Pulse Survey

Phase 4.0 is currently scheduled to collect data from January 9 to April 1, 2024. Phase 4.0 introduces a cycle-based approach for data collection and dissemination, replacing the previous method of referencing 'weeks'. This phase is structured around three distinct collection cycles, each followed by a scheduled data release:

Cycle 1: Data collection from January 9 to February 5, 2024, with data release on February 22, 2024.

Cycle 2: Data collection from February 6 to March 4, 2024, with data release on March 21, 2024.

Cycle 3: Data collection from March 5 to April 1, 2024, with data release on April 18, 2024.

Users can access the Phase 4.0 questionnaire on the Measuring Emergent Social and Economic Matters Facing U.S. Households website, and all previous questionnaires from the survey are available on the Technical Documentation webpage.

In response to the changes in content for Phase 4.0, modifications have been made to the Household Pulse Survey data products. These include the interactive data tool and the detailed table package, which have been updated to reflect the new and revised content.

New Content for Phase 4.0

Social Support and Engagement Questions: SOC1, SOC2, SOCInd1-4, and SOCInd1EXP introduce questions about social and emotional support, feelings of loneliness, and engagement in community activities.

SOC1: How often do you get the social and emotional support you need?

SOC2: How often do you feel lonely?

SOCInd1: In a typical week, how often do you talk on the telephone with family, friends, or neighbors?

SOCInd2: How often do you get together with friends or relatives?

SOCInd3: How often do you attend church or religious services?

SOCInd4: How often do you attend meetings of the clubs or organizations you belong to?

SOCInd1EXP: In a typical week, how often do you text or message with family, friends, or neighbors?

New Vaccine Questions:

VAC1 (new): What was the date of your most recent COVID-19 vaccine?

VAC3 (new): There is a vaccine that was recently recommended for some people that helps prevent the respiratory virus called RSV. Have you received the RSV vaccine? (Universe = people age ≥60 years)

Updated Content for Phase 4.0

The following questions have been moved to different locations in the survey for Phase 4.0:

INF1, INF2, INF5, INF6: These questions ask about infant formula use and availability. New location: between questions D12 and D13, which are about children in the household and school enrollment, respectively.

EMP1 thru EMP4: These questions ask about employment status and income. New location: after question D15, which is about military status.

SPN5_DAYSTW/ SPN5_DAYSTW_2: These questions ask about the days spent teleworking. New location: after question EMP4, which is about the reason for not working for pay or profit.

DIS1 thru DIS6: These questions ask about disability benefits and services. New location: after

question SPN5_DAYSTW_2, which is about teleworking.

ND1 thru ND5g: These questions ask about natural disasters. New location: after question FD7_new, which is about food insecurity.

HLTH1 thru HLTH4, MH1 thru MH4: These questions ask about general health and mental health status. New location: after question DIS6, which is about disability-related difficulty in communicating.

HSE1 thru HSE12: These questions ask about housing. New location: after question ND5g, which is about challenges after experiencing a natural disaster.

VAC1: This question asks about COVID-19 vaccination status. New location: after question GAS1, which is about gasoline use and costs.

VAC8_B thru VAC8_C: These questions ask about testing positive for COVID-19. New location: after question VAC1(new), which is about the date of the most recent COVID-19 vaccine.

PASC1 thru PASC4: These questions ask about long-term coronavirus symptoms. New location: between questions VAC8_C, which is about testing positive for COVID-19.

HLTH8: This question asks about health insurance coverage. New location: after question PASC4, which is about impact of long-term coronavirus symptoms.

Removed Content for Phase 4.0

In addition to the revised questions, some content from Phase 3.10 had been removed for Phase 4.0. The following is a list of the questions that are no longer part of the survey instrument.

HLTH14: This question inquired about the mental health of the children in the household.

MEDICAID_1: This question found out if the respondent had ever had Medicaid coverage since January 1, 2023.

MEDICAID_2: This question asked for the main cause why the respondent no longer had Medicaid coverage.

VAC2: This question asked how much time had passed since the respondent received their most recent dose of the COVID-19 vaccine or booster.

VAC5_rev: This question asked how much time had passed since the children in the household received their most recent dose of the COVID-19 vaccine or booster, by age group.

TREAT1: This question asked if the respondent used Paxlovid or Lagevrio for their most recent COVID-19 infection.

COVID-Test2: This question asked how the respondent would deal with the change in policy that mandated testing or vaccination for certain activities or workplaces.

EMP6: This question asked what type of business, industry, or organization the respondent worked for.

EMPUI1: This question asked if the respondent had applied for Unemployment Insurance (UI benefits since June 1, 2023.

EMPUI2: This question asked if the respondent had received Unemployment Insurance (UI benefits since June 1, 2023.

EMPUI3: This question asked if the respondent had received Unemployment Insurance (UI benefits in the last 7 days.

INFLATE3: This question asked what adjustments the respondent had made or planned to make to handle the rise in prices.

SPN6: This question asked what sources of income or savings the respondent or their household members used to cover their spending needs in the last 7 days.

SHORTAGE1: This question asked if the respondent or their household members had been directly impacted by shortage of medical products in the past month.

SHORTAGE2A: This question asked how the respondent or their household members reacted to shortage of critical products.

INF4_rev: This question was similar to SHORTAGE2A but only applied to households with infants who faced a shortage of infant formula.

INF7: This question asked how much infant formula the respondent had on hand currently.

ND5H: This question asked if the respondent had trouble accessing medical care or medicines in the first month after facing a natural disaster.

Q28: Asked respondents about their spending on prepared food in the last 7 days.